Case study 2: Coffee table

National 5 · Practical Woodworking · Answers and marking guidance

Award one mark per correct point unless stated. Other valid answers should be credited. Sketches can gain full marks if they show enough detail.

1 (a) State the ratio normally used for the thickness of a tenon. (1 mark)

- One third of the thickness of the wood

1 (b) Explain why a mortise and tenon joint is suitable for the table. (2 marks)

- Large glue area / tenon locked inside the mortise
- So the joint is strong and resists racking (sideways forces) when the table is used

2 Describe two reasons for dry cramping. (2 marks)

- To check all the joints fit and close up
- To check the frame is square (equal diagonals)
- To set the cramps to size before glue is applied

Any 2 points.

3 Explain one reason for choosing oak. (2 marks)

- Oak is harder and stronger than pine
- So the legs resist dents and knocks and look attractive for longer

4 (a) Name a label that shows timber is sustainably sourced. (1 mark)

- FSC (or PEFC)

4 (b) Describe one benefit of using sustainably sourced timber. (2 marks)

- Trees are replanted so forests are not lost
- Wildlife habitats are protected / long-term supply of timber

Total: 10 marks